



Kindergarten Readiness

A Guide to Help Prepare Your Child for Kindergarten

Congratulations! Starting Kindergarten is an exciting milestone for your child and your family.

Below is a list of skills that Kindergarten teachers may observe during the first weeks of school. It is important to remember that every child develops at their own pace, and children are not expected to have mastered all these skills before entering Kindergarten.

The list below is meant to serve as a general guide to help you better understand what teachers are looking for and give you an idea of what skills you can be supporting at home to help your child feel more confident and successful as they begin school.



Independent & Self-Help Skills

- Wash and dry hands
- Use the bathroom independently
- Use tissue and understand the need to cover coughs/sneezes
- Open snack and lunch containers
- Clean up toys and materials
- Begin to dress themselves (buttoning, zipping, etc.)



Language Skills

- Speak in complete sentences
- Be able to express needs and wants with words
- Follow 1-2 step directions
- Participate in simple conversations
- Understand and use basic vocabulary



Social & Emotional Skills

- Separate from caregiver within a reasonable timeframe, and if needed, able to accept support from school staff
- Participate in group activities
- Understand the concept of sharing and able to cooperate when reminded
- Play with other children
- Show growing self-control (begin to manage small frustrations with support)
- Begin to recognize and talk about feelings

Early Academic Skills



Literacy

- Recognize some letters (especially those in their name)
- May identify a few letter sounds
- Recognize their first name in print
- Listen to a story and answer simple questions
- Show interest in books, drawing and writing
- Understand how to hold a book and turn pages



Math

- Count to 10 or higher
- Identify colors
- Know basic shapes (circle, triangle, square, rectangle)
- Understand simple concepts (big/small, same/different, first/last)



Fine Motor Skills

- Hold a crayon or pencil
- Draw simple pictures
- Attempt to write their name
- Use scissors for basic cutting